

Greetings aspiring Bioinformaticians!

Below is information about the upcoming summer program. Please email questions to Leslie Coonrod (coonrod@uoregon.edu).

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Program specific information

Start date

The program begins with orientation, “Professional Development Week”, **Tuesday, June 16 – Thursday, June 18, 2026** (no activities will be scheduled on Juneteenth, June 19th). Professional Development Week will include:

- Introductions to the Knight Campus Graduate Internship Program students and staff
- Introductions to the Bioinformatics and Genomics cohort and program faculty
- Summer term program overview
- Team building activities
- Inter- and intra-track networking opportunities

- Professional development training
- Onboarding

A detailed schedule will be sent in the coming weeks.

The first course, Bi 621, begins Monday, June 22, at 10:00 AM. Official course meeting times are 10:00 AM – 4:00 PM, with a lunch break 12:00 – 1:30 PM. Some lab sessions in Bi 622 will run beyond these times, but no earlier than 9 AM. We will provide you with detailed course schedules through Canvas.

Summer registration

Registration for summer term opens May 4, 2026. Please use the below course registration numbers (CRNs). You must register for all three courses. **Please register by May 12th.** If you are applying for financial aid, we recommend that you register as soon as possible.

Course #	CRN	Course Title	Course Dates
BI621	40580	Computational Methods in Genomic Analysis	June 22 – July 17, 2026
BI622	40581	Genomics Techniques	July 20 – Aug 7, 2026
BI623	40582	Advanced Topics in Genomics Analysis	Aug 17 – Sept 11, 2026

**Note: There will be no required classes July 3, Aug 10 – 14, Sept 7, and Sept 14 – 25.*

Fall term begins Sept 28.

To register, log onto [Duckweb](#). Login with your **UO ID number (beginning with 95)** and **Personal Access Code (PAC)**. You should be able to access these via the "Status Update" section of your [application status portal](#). Once logged in, click on the registration menu then choose “Add/Drop Classes”. In this form, enter the CRNs in the blank fields at the bottom of the page and click submit to register. If you have any trouble registering, please contact KCacademics (kcacademics@uoregon.edu) for assistance.

Inclusion network

As a Knight Campus Graduate Internship Program student, you are invited to participate in our **Inclusion Workshop Series!** The series is made up of regularly scheduled meetings, each focused around a different topic related to inclusion. They are designed as extended leadership training, focused around building trust, community, and nourishing a sense of belonging during your time at the University of Oregon. As professionals, we hope to empower you with the foundational knowledge necessary to be inclusive team members and future inclusive leaders. Research shows that diverse and inclusive teams are much more successful, so it is in all our best interest to learn how to work well together!

During the summer, the workshops will be on **Tuesday evenings from 6:00 – 7:30 PM in the Knight Campus Seminar Room**. Dinner will be provided for all students prior to the Inclusion Workshops, regardless of whether they choose to attend the meeting that evening.

Students that attend meetings regularly will also be able to attend the annual Inclusion Symposium (August 21st), featuring a panel of leadership in industry, program alumni, and a keynote speaker. Stay tuned for more information and a schedule of meeting topics!

Academic Preparation

Students wishing to prepare for upcoming coursework should email (or Slack!) Leslie for advice specific to their situation. You should also log into Canvas after registering for class. There is a Module to complete before the term starts so that you (and your computer!) will be ready for the first day of class.

Communication with the program

We will use

- the [UOBGMP 2026 Slack workspace](#),

- [UO email](#),
- [Canvas](#),
- [Zoom](#),
- and [GitHub](#)

for dissemination of program and specific course information. If you have not received your invitation to the UOBGMP_2026 Slack workspace, please contact [Leslie Coonrod](#). We highly recommend downloading the Slack app on your laptop and/or phone. If you do not already have a GitHub account, please [create a GitHub account](#). Be sure to email (or Slack!) Leslie your username.

Some comments about computers

You will need a laptop for this program. There are a limited number of emergency technology scholarships available. You may request an emergency technology scholarship if:

- your current laptop does not meet our specifications, and the purchase of a new laptop is a hardship, or
- your laptop becomes unusable at some point during the on-campus portion of the program.

Students may request a maximum of one emergency technology scholarship. Reach out to Leslie for information about how to apply for these funds.

Consider that you may be eligible for education discounts if you are purchasing a new laptop.

Laptop requirements

Hardware

- Laptop, at least 13"
- Minimum 16GB RAM
- Sufficient hard drive free space (50 GB free space is probably sufficient - more is better), SSD recommended
- Webcam (can be built into your laptop)
- Microphone (can be built into your laptop – we recommend testing over Zoom with a friend to be sure it is of high enough quality so that you are clearly understood)
- Macs:
A 2022 or newer MacBook Air or MacBook Pro will probably be sufficient but be sure to verify you have enough RAM. We do NOT recommend the MacBook Neo. Contact us if you have concerns.
- Windows:
Contact us if you have concerns

Software

- One of the following operating systems:
 - Windows 11 Home or Pro
 - MacOS 26 Tahoe
 - MacOS 15 Sequoia*
- We do not recommend “education” versions of Windows, and be sure you are not in [“S” mode](#)
- Currently running something else? **Time to switch!** Contact us if you have questions.

**Note: unless you have a very compelling reason to continue using Sequoia, we strongly recommend you upgrade to Tahoe before arriving on campus*

Backup system

In addition to your computer, you will need a way to BACK UP YOUR DATA! Hard drives are NOT infallible, and at some point, yours WILL die. An automatic backup system is best.

Please reach out to us if you need help/advice or if you have ANY questions.

Staff contacts

General questions

Lynde Ritzow: lynde@uoregon.edu

Betsy Tanenbaum: btanen@uoregon.edu

Allison Fujinaga: afujinag@uoregon.edu

Inclusion meetings & Symposium questions

Betsy Tanenbaum: btanen@uoregon.edu

Housing questions

Allison Fujinaga: afujinag@uoregon.edu

Registration, Financial Aid, and Billing questions

Knight Campus Academics Team: kcacademics@uoregon.edu

Curriculum and technology questions

Leslie Coonrod: coonrod@uoregon.edu

Bioinformatics instructors

Leslie Coonrod: coonrod@uoregon.edu

Jason Sydes: sydes@uoregon.edu

Maxine Wren: mws@uoregon.edu

Hope Healey: hhealey@uoregon.edu

Getting started as a UO student

We recommend you visit the [to-do list for newly admitted UO graduate students](#), especially if you are an international student. You should also visit [One Stop Student Resources](#) for resources on Financial Aid, Wellness/Mental Health support, campus jobs, technology support, housing/dining, and much more. Additionally, check out [One Stop for Graduate students](#) and the “Student Diversity and Inclusion Resources” pdf that was sent along with this welcome letter.

UO ID number

Your UO ID number is a 9-digit number (beginning with 95). You can find your UO ID number in your [application status portal](#). Previous UO students will use their same ID number.

Email / Duck ID

To receive your Duck ID (or username) and email address, you will need to follow the steps under "[Claim Your Duck ID](#)". Check your UOoregon email regularly while you are a student. We use your UOoregon email address for communication throughout your time in the program.

Accessibility

The University of Oregon and the KCGIP are dedicated to fostering inclusive, equitable, and accessible learning environments for all students. The [Accessible Education Center](#) (AEC) assists students with

disabilities in reducing barriers in the educational experience. You may be eligible for accommodations for a variety of disabilities – apparent disabilities, such as a mobility or physical disability, or non-apparent disabilities, such as chronic illnesses or psychological disabilities. If you have or think you have a disability and experience academic barriers, please contact the Accessible Education Center (Location: 360 Oregon Hall; 541-346-1155; uoaec@uoregon.edu) to discuss appropriate accommodations or support. The details of your disability will be kept confidential with the AEC and you are not expected to share this information with others. However, you are invited to discuss any approved accommodations or access needs at any time with program staff.

Final degree transcripts

The registrar requires a final degree transcript for any degree received at the bachelor level or above. If you are graduating spring term, please send your final official transcript to the Office of Admissions, address below, after your degree has been conferred. This may happen after classes begin.

Students who graduated prior to Spring 2026 will be blocked from summer registration until their final degree transcripts are received by the Office of Admissions:

Office of Admissions
1217 University of Oregon
Eugene, OR 97403-1217

Electronic transcripts may be sent to registrar@uoregon.edu.

Financial aid

Your Duck ID (or UO username) is required to apply for financial aid. If you were recently admitted, you may not have received this information. You may call the registrar (541-346-2935) to receive your PAC and UO ID number so that you can log on to Duckweb and claim your Duck ID. The priority deadline to apply for summer financial aid is May 15th; please register for courses by this date to receive aid in a timely manner.

Once you're registered, you should be able to claim your aid via Duckweb. The financial aid office will send you an email letting you know when your award is available through Duckweb. You may not be able to see your actual award until closer to mid-June.

Summer financial aid

Summer aid is separate from the academic year, and you will need to apply for both. Summer 2026 is an extension of 2025/2026, so you will need to fill out a 2025/2026 FAFSA and complete a separate FAFSA for 2026/2027. If you already filled out a FAFSA for 2025/2026, be sure to add the University of Oregon (UO school code: 003223) and indicated that you are now a graduate student. If you are an international student, you should contact the [International Student and Scholar Services office](#).

Students have reported that their summer financial aid disbursement is often lower than expected. The financial aid office assumes all graduate students are registering for 9 credits (full-time for grad students) and packages aid for this amount. Because you will be registering for more than 9 credits, this can be rectified with an email to the financial aid office once classes start. Their office will then confirm the higher credit load and adjust accordingly. The KCacademics team can provide a template you can use for this purpose. If it's not adjusted before your bill becomes due July 1st, you should not be on the hook for interest due to the delay. Let KCacademics know if that happens.

Grad PLUS loan

A basic FAFSA has a per-term maximum of \$6833. A Grad PLUS loan can bridge the gap between what a basic FAFSA will cover and what you actually need based on UO's projected budget.

The Grad PLUS loan will sunset July 1, 2026. Be sure your loan application is submitted in well in advance and follow all the steps required on the checklist to ensure that aid can be dispersed before July 1st. You can find a link to the [Grad PLUS application](#) on the financial aid website.

Set up Direct Deposit in DuckWeb

If you are receiving financial aid or scholarships, direct deposit will allow refunds to be deposited directly into your bank account - otherwise they will be sent via snail mail. You can find more information on how to set up yours on the [Refunds and Direct Deposit webpage](#).

Financial aid questions

For further information about financial aid, please go directly to the [Financial Aid Office](#). They are very helpful and will respond to questions via email or phone, although calling may be faster.

UO health insurance

You are eligible to buy UO student health insurance as long as you are admitted and enrolled in one or more classes and actively seeking a degree. For more details, visit the [UO Health Benefits Plan website](#). Questions? Reach out to Margarita Bonebrake (uostudentinsure@uoregon.edu or 541-346-2832).

Note for international students: International students are required to have health insurance and are [automatically enrolled for the UO plan](#) (you should have been notified of this). If you already have insurance, you can request a waiver from the requirement before July 1st. Note that some company insurance may not qualify for a waiver. Please reach out to Margarita above for specific questions.

Housing

Past students have been able to find month-to-month and short-term leases. We do not recommend signing a longer lease because most students begin internships in early April. You can find more details in the 2026 housing document that should be in your email. Feel free to use the cohort Slack to reach out to fellow students if you're looking for roommates, or [email Allison](#) to get on the roommate list.

Allergens

Grass seed pollen appears to be at its peak right around our start date. If you are sensitive, you may want to plan to have allergy meds on hand! Check out [current pollen counts](#).

On-campus work information

GE information (fall and winter terms only)

Students interested in Graduate Employee (GE) positions for fall term must apply directly to the department of interest. Information can be found on the [Graduate School website](#). Keep in mind your course load in the fall/winter – be sure to carefully consider your commitments, especially the fact that you'll be interviewing for internship positions during winter term. Past students who have held GE positions say it is possible to manage coursework and a GE position at the same time but requires strong prioritization and time management skills.

Other work opportunities

Historically, students have held a variety of positions during the fall/winter including:

- [Student athlete tutor](#)
- [Duck rides](#)
- Positions found on [Handshake](#)

Students are discouraged from working during the summer term. The summer coursework is intense and immersive; historically, students have not been able to balance summer courses in addition to external work. Please contact Leslie if you have questions.

[A word about getting around Eugene](#)

Eugene is [bike friendly](#) and there is ample bike parking on campus. There is also a [bicycle share program](#) where UO students a discounted rate. Bike registration is required for everyone who bikes to campus. Register your bike at [Project 529](#).

Bikes are a hot commodity in Eugene. We highly recommend a U-lock and a cable lock for the back wheel. Please remember to WEAR YOUR HELMET and to use front and rear lights after dark! STAY SAFE!

In addition to biking, Eugene has a [bus service](#) that all UO students can ride FOR FREE by using the [UMO app](#).

Visit the [UO Transportation website](#) for more information about getting to and from campus via bike, bus, or car.

Looking forward to seeing all of you!

Sincerely, the Bioinformatics and Genomics team